

Acceptable Use of Artificial Intelligence & Data Protection Policy

Policy owner	IT / Security
Effective date	September 2026
Applies to	Employees, contractors, temporary staff, and other authorized users

Purpose

Northstar permits the use of approved artificial intelligence tools when they support legitimate business work and are used in a manner consistent with company security, privacy, confidentiality, intellectual property, and records requirements. AI may assist employees with work, but it does not replace employee judgment, required approvals, or accountability for the final result.

1. Approved Business Use

Employees may use company-approved AI tools for routine business activities such as drafting, summarizing, brainstorming, translation, formatting, coding assistance, documentation, analysis support, and training support. AI may also be used to automate repetitive work when the automation has an identified business owner, does not bypass an approval or control, and is reviewed before it is relied on in production or customer-facing work.

Only public, synthetic, de-identified, or specifically authorized internal information may be entered into an AI tool unless IT / Security has approved the tool for the applicable data classification. Employees are expected to use the lowest sensitivity data necessary to complete the task.

2. Prohibited and Restricted Use

Employees may not enter passwords, authentication secrets, private keys, access tokens, security recovery information, or other credentials into an AI service. Customer confidential information, regulated personal information, employee medical information, payroll or banking data, government identifiers, and other restricted information may not be entered into a public or unapproved AI tool.

Source code, security architecture, vulnerability information, contracts, pricing, nonpublic financial information, and proprietary business plans may be used only in an approved enterprise environment and only when the employee has a legitimate business need and appropriate access. If a tool retains prompts, uses submitted content for model training, exposes content to third parties, or has unclear data-handling terms, it is not approved for confidential information unless IT / Security has completed a review and authorized its use.

Employees may not use AI to impersonate another person, create a false approval or signature, fabricate records, evade company controls, or intentionally misrepresent AI-generated material as independently verified work.

3. Review and Accountability

Employees are responsible for reviewing AI-assisted work before it is used. Material facts, calculations, citations, code, legal or compliance statements, financial information, and customer-facing claims must be verified against an appropriate source. An employee may not rely on an AI response simply because it appears confident or complete.

AI may support research or analysis related to hiring, discipline, termination, compensation, performance ratings, safety, credit, or other high-impact decisions, but it may not make the final decision. The responsible manager or

employee must apply the approved decision process, review relevant evidence, and be able to explain the basis for the decision without relying on the statement that an AI system produced the answer.

4. Intellectual Property and Confidentiality

Employees must respect copyright, license restrictions, confidentiality obligations, customer agreements, and internal ownership requirements when providing source material to an AI tool or using AI-generated content. Company confidential information remains confidential regardless of whether an AI tool was used to create, summarize, or transform it.

5. New Tools and Integrations

Employees may not connect a new AI tool, browser extension, plug-in, API, or integration to Northstar systems or company data without approval. Requests for a new tool must identify the business purpose, vendor, data types involved, retention and model-training terms, access model, integration method, and business owner. IT / Security may approve, restrict, condition, or deny use and may require an enterprise account, contract terms, logging, access controls, or additional review.

6. Incident Reporting

Any accidental disclosure of restricted information, credential exposure, unauthorized AI integration, suspected privacy or security incident, or AI-generated output that may have materially affected a customer or business decision must be reported promptly through the established incident-reporting process. Employees should preserve relevant information and follow instructions from IT / Security regarding containment and follow-up.

7. Enforcement

Use of AI tools in violation of this policy may result in removal of access, additional training, corrective action, or other action consistent with company policy and the seriousness of the issue. Northstar may suspend or restrict use of any AI tool when security, privacy, legal, contractual, or operational risk is identified.

Before using an AI tool for company work, employees should confirm that the tool is approved, the information is authorized for that environment, and any material output will receive appropriate human review. If any of those conditions cannot be met, the tool or data should not be used until the issue is resolved.